

Pendulum clock

Timekeeping in the past was often hit-or-miss. The invention of the pendulum clock ensured that things ran like clockwork.

Keeping the world ON TIME



Sundials used the Sun's position in the sky to tell the time.

Early clocks

People have always tried to keep track of the time. More than 9,000 years ago, people used **SUNDIALS**. In ancient Egypt and Babylon (modern-day Iraq), the **constant drip of water** was used to measure time. Mechanical clocks were invented in the 1300s, driven by **falling weights**, but they did not measure time accurately.

It paved the way for...

Starting in the **1500s**, **POCKET WATCHES** were carried by the wealthy, though they weren't very accurate at first.



Precise pendulums

Italian inventor **GALILEO GALILEI** realized that the regular swing of a **pendulum** was a good way to measure time, but it was Dutch mathematician **CHRISTIAAN HUYGENS** who made clocks start ticking with precision. His pendulum clock of 1656 counted the seconds ***much more accurately*** than previous weight-driven clocks. It was so reliable that Huygens fitted his clock with a **second hand** as well as minute and hour hands.

By the way...
In addition to inventing the most accurate clock in the world, I built a telescope and discovered the rings of the planet Saturn.



Scottish clockmaker **Alexander Bain** invented the first **ELECTRIC CLOCK** in **1840**.